

Elements Handpans — Go-Live Checklist

For: Dany · **Storefront:** elementshandpans.com (*live — domain connected*)

Checkout: Shopify hosted checkout — payments, shipping, duties and orders all run natively in Shopify.

Launch scope: Origins collection + accessories only. The **Signature Series is shelved for launch** — it's made in Iran, which carries EU sanctions/import questions we're resolving separately (see §2). It's hidden on the storefront and set to Draft in Shopify, so it can't be seen or bought; bringing it back later is a one-line toggle.

Status: The store is **mechanically complete and verified** — payments, EU shipping, duties, tax and the Shopify checkout are all live, and a test EU checkout confirmed they render correctly together (€79 shipping + duties + import VAT + PayPal/Google Pay). The **domain is connected** and the **policies are written, legally reviewed and published in Shopify**.

Checkout is still held behind Shopify's **"Opening soon" password page**, so no real customer can buy yet — a deliberate safety gate. The site is also deliberately **hidden from Google** until launch. With Signature shelved, the Iran sanctions question no longer blocks launch. **One item remains before going public: appointing an EU representative (§3).**

Already done (no action needed)

- ☒ **All products** — descriptions, specs, prices, photos, SEO. (*Launch shows the 9 Origins builds + accessories; the 7 Signature instruments are built but hidden — see launch scope above.*)
- ☒ **Base currency = EUR.** Prices show and charge in euros (e.g. €1,300).
- ☒ **Collections** — Origins and Cases & Accessories are live. (*Signature Series is hidden on the storefront and Draft in Shopify — shelved for launch, restorable with a one-line toggle.*)
- ☒ **Payments are live.** Shopify checkout takes cards via **Stripe** (connected to your Cornerstone Devs account) and **PayPal**. Live mode, cards + PayPal enabled.
- ☒ **Duties & import taxes set up (DDP).** For the **EU and Indonesia**, import duty and VAT are calculated by Avalara and **added as separate lines at checkout** (0.5% Shopify fee on those orders). The customer pays them up front, so **no surprise customs bill on delivery** — a genuine selling point for high-value instruments.
- ☒ **Tax handling decided + set.** You keep your listed price; import VAT is added on top at checkout (not absorbed). Sales tax is correctly set to "not collecting" (you're not EU VAT-registered).
- ☒ **Card-statement name** shows **ELEMENTS HANDPANS** (reduces disputes).
- ☒ **EU shipping is set up.** A flat **€79 "Standard"** rate covers all 27 EU countries — the coverage gap that blocked checkout is fixed. Rest-of-world is intentionally off for launch. (*€79 and the "5–8 business day" estimate are provisional placeholders — confirm against a real carrier quote + actual dispatch times.*)
- ☒ **Policies written, reviewed and published.** Shipping, Refunds/Returns, Privacy, Terms and the EU-required Contact information are all live in Shopify (behind the password). They've been reviewed against **PIPEDA, CASL, Ontario's Consumer Protection Act, 2002 and Sale of Goods Act**, plus EU consumer law, and updated accordingly. All the blanks are filled — see §3 for the single remaining item.

- ☒ **Legal entity set.** Merchant of record and data controller = **Michelle Ackers, sole proprietor carrying on business as Cornerstone Devs**, 525 Adelaide St W, Toronto, ON M5V 0N7. Governing law = **Ontario, Canada**.
- ☒ **Domain connected.** **elementsandpans.com** is live on the storefront (auto-renews Jul 2027). `www` redirects to the bare domain, SSL issued. *This also unlocks Apple Pay / Google Pay.*
- ☒ **Hidden from Google until launch.** The store is reachable at the real domain but carries `noindex` + a `robots.txt` block, so nothing gets indexed while checkout is still gated. One toggle flips it at launch (see Launch steps).
- ☒ **Storefront flipped to Shopify checkout + verified end-to-end.** Buy buttons now route to Shopify's hosted checkout. A test EU (Germany) checkout rendered correctly: €1,300 product · **€79 shipping** · **€89.64 duties** · **€279.04 import VAT** (19%, added on top) · **Total €1,747.68**, with **PayPal + Google Pay** and cards offered. *(No payment taken — we verified the checkout renders, we didn't transact.)*

Note on orders: with Shopify checkout, every paid order lands in your **Shopify admin** ▶ **Orders**, with the customer's details and shipping address, ready for you to fulfil by hand. (The earlier database order-recording we built was for a different checkout approach and is now on standby.)

Note on going public — there are two switches, and they flip together. (1) Remove Shopify's "Opening soon" password (Online Store ▶ Preferences), and (2) turn search-engine indexing back on (a one-line change we make, then redeploy). Flip only the password and the store can take orders but stays invisible to Google; flip only indexing and Google finds a shop that can't sell. We'll do both in one go when you say the word.

What we need from you

1. ☒ Shipping — EU done

EU shipping is live: a flat **€79 "Standard"** rate now covers all 27 EU countries, fixing the checkout-coverage gap (13 EU countries previously had no rate and couldn't check out; the old rupiah placeholders are gone). Rest-of-world is off at launch by design — we'll add regions deliberately once there's revenue. *Live carrier rates (real-time DHL/UPS quotes) need Shopify's Advanced plan (~\$399/mo vs current \$65), so we're on fixed rates for now.*

Two things to firm up — neither blocks launch:

- ☐ **Validate the €79** against one real DHL/UPS quote for a ~6 kg parcel. It's sized to protect margin; better to trim it down later than to lose money on it now.
- ☐ **Indonesia domestic rate + real transit times.** These depend on the ship-from answer in §2 — if instruments dispatch from China, an Indonesian order is *also* an import, not a domestic one. The "5–8 day" delivery estimate is a placeholder until you give actual dispatch + transit times.

Since duties are collected separately at checkout, the €79 should reflect the **all-in carrier cost including the DDP surcharge** — not the duty itself.

2. 🟡 Product origin & steel grade

Getting this right matters: **country of origin is declared to customs and drives the duty calculation**, and it's stated to customers in the policies. **None of this blocks launch anymore** — the one item that was a red flag (Iran) only applies to Signature, which is now shelved.

For the Origins launch (needed to finish specs, not to go live):

- ☐ **Confirm Origins ship-from country + steel grade with Xi.** The catalogue says Origins = made by Xi in China; you mentioned "from China." We need the exact **stainless steel grade** (catalogue currently says *"final supplier grade to confirm"*) and confirmation of **where each order ships from** to the customer. (*The store's fulfilment location is currently set to Bali, Indonesia — we'll align it to whatever's correct.*) A supplier message covering this is drafted and ready to send.

Before Signature ever comes back (parked, not on the launch path):

- ☐ ⚠️ **Iran-origin sanctions check.** The Signature instruments are made by Amir Raga in Iran, which carries EU sanctions and import considerations a normal store never hits. Confirm this with whoever handles freight **before** re-listing Signature. A supplier message to Amir asking about EU customs history is drafted and ready to send. Until this is cleared, Signature stays hidden.

3. 🔴 EU representative (GDPR Art. 27) — the one thing left before launch

The policies are **done**: written, reviewed against Ontario/Canada and EU law, all blanks filled, and published in Shopify. Support email is `hello@elementshandpans.com`, 432 Hz is treated as a standard tuning (full 14-day EU returns), and support is email-only at launch.

One genuine legal obligation remains:

- ☐ **Appoint an EU representative.** Because the business is Canadian and ships **only** into the EU, GDPR Art. 27 requires a named representative inside the EU as a contact point for customers and regulators. The "occasional processing" exemption doesn't apply — selling to the EU is the business model, not incidental. Outsourced services run **~€200–500/year** (VeraSafe, DataRep, GDPR Local and similar). Once appointed, send us the name + EU address and we'll drop it into the Privacy policy, where a placeholder is already waiting.

Not doing this is an Art. 83 fine risk (up to €10M or 2% of turnover) for something that costs a few hundred euros to fix. It's the last real box to tick.

4. ✅ Domain — done

elementshandpans.com is live and serving the storefront, with `www` redirecting to the bare domain and SSL issued. It auto-renews in July 2027.

- ☐ **Optional, now unlocked:** enable **Apple Pay / Google Pay** in Shopify. They needed a verified domain, which you now have, and they measurably lift mobile conversion.

Launch steps — our side

Once your inputs land, these are quick and we handle them:

1. ✅ **Done** — Payments (Stripe + PayPal), duties/DDP, tax display, statement descriptor, **EU shipping (€79) + coverage fix.**

2. ☒ **Done** — **Storefront switched to Shopify checkout and verified end-to-end** (gated EU test showed shipping + duties + VAT + wallets rendering correctly).
 3. ☒ **Done** — **Policies written, legally reviewed and published** in Shopify (incl. the EU-required contact information).
 4. ☒ **Done** — **Domain connected** (elementshandpans.com, www redirect, SSL) and the site held back from Google until launch.
 5. **Add the EU representative's details** to the Privacy policy as soon as you've appointed one (§3).
 6. **Validate the €79 rate** and add Indonesia/other regions once Xi's numbers are confirmed (§1, §2).
 7. Enable **Apple Pay / Google Pay** (now unblocked by the domain).
 8. **Go live — both switches together:** remove the **"Opening soon" password** *and re-enable search indexing* (one-line change + redeploy on our side).
 9. Run a **real test purchase** through the live checkout, confirm it lands in Shopify Orders, then refund it.
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Definition of "live" — acceptance test

The store is live when **all** of these pass:

- ☐ A real customer can add a handpan to the cart and **pay successfully** (real card or PayPal).
 - ☒ Checkout shows the correct **EUR price**, a **shipping** option, and the **duty + import-tax** lines. ☒
Verified via a gated EU test checkout — €79 shipping, €89.64 duty, €279.04 import VAT, total €1,747.68.
 - ☐ The order appears in **Shopify admin** ▶ **Orders** with the customer's email and shipping address, ready to fulfil.
 - ☐ A test order was placed through the live Shopify checkout and refunded without errors.
 - ☐ **The first real order** completes end-to-end — payment in Stripe, order in Shopify, ready to ship.
 - ☒ **Policies and domain are live on the site.** ☒ *elementshandpans.com is connected; all policies + contact information are published in Shopify.*
 - ☐ The **EU representative** is appointed and named in the Privacy policy.
 - ☐ Search indexing is **switched back on** and the store is findable on Google.
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Where things stand

The build is done, the domain is live, and the policies are written, legally reviewed and published. Payments, EU shipping, duties, tax and the Shopify checkout all work end-to-end, confirmed with a real gated EU test checkout. We're launching **Origins-only**, with Signature shelved until its Iran-origin customs question is cleared — which took the one hard blocker off the launch path.

Exactly one thing now stands between you and going live: appointing an EU representative (§3) — a ~€200–500/year service, required because you're a Canadian business shipping into the EU. Sort that, send us the details, and we flip the two go-live switches (password off, indexing on) the same day.

Everything else is optional polish that can happen after launch: Xi's steel grade and real transit times (\$2), validating the €79 rate (\$1), and turning on Apple/Google Pay (\$4).